

AMCAT ADVANCED PREP

Para-Jumbles & Full Verbal Drill

The 3-step method · 90-second timing discipline · synonym & antonym mastery

TRAINER SESSION DECK

The 3-Step Para-Jumble Method

Every para-jumble, no matter the topic, can be solved with the same three moves.

1

Find the Opening

Look for the sentence that introduces the subject in general terms — it never starts with a backward-pointing pronoun or connector.

2

Find the Closing

Look for the sentence with a concluding or forward-looking tone — it often signals a result, consequence, or future outlook.

3

Chain with Connectors

Use pronouns (this, it, such) and linking words (however, therefore, moreover) to lock the middle sentences into place.

Spot the Opening Sentence

SIGNALS TO LOOK FOR

- Introduces the topic in general terms
- No pronoun that refers back to something (it, this, they, such)
- No connector that assumes prior context (however, therefore, also)
- Often states a broad fact, trend, or claim

QUICK CHECK

“Could this sentence stand alone as the first line of a news article?” If yes, it's likely the opener.

EXAMPLE

✓ **Opener:** “Solar power has moved from a niche technology to a mainstream source of electricity in just two decades.”

✗ **Not an opener:** “This shift is largely due to a dramatic fall in the cost of photovoltaic panels.”

(starts with “This” — it's pointing back to something already introduced)

Spot the Closing Sentence

SIGNALS TO LOOK FOR

- Concluding tone — as a result, therefore, thus, consequently
- Forward-looking statement — is expected to, will likely, going forward
- Summarizes the impact or implication of everything before it
- Reads naturally as the “last word” on the topic

QUICK CHECK

“Does this sentence wrap up the idea, or does it still need something after it?” If it wraps up, it's the closer.

EXAMPLE

✓ **Closer:** “If this decline continues, farmers could face serious crop shortages within a few years.”

✗ **Not a closer:** “Consequently, farmers today rely heavily on managed bee colonies to pollinate their crops.”
(states a present-day result, but doesn't point forward — a real closer often does)

STEP 3 OF 3

Chain the Middle with Connectors

Circle every pronoun and linking word before you try to order the sentences.

CONTRAST

however
although
despite
but

CAUSE & EFFECT

therefore
thus
consequently
as a result

ADDITION

moreover
furthermore
in addition
also

REFERENCE

this
these
it
such
that reason

Reference words (this, it, such) are the most powerful clue — the sentence they appear in almost never opens the paragraph.

TIMING DISCIPLINE

90 Seconds, No More

A fixed routine keeps you fast without guessing.

15 sec

Scan all sentences

20 sec

Spot opening & closing

40 sec

Sequence the middle

15 sec

Verify start to finish

= 90 SECONDS TOTAL

If you're not confident after 90 seconds, mark your best guess and move on. A para-jumble you return to later with a fresh eye is easier than one you've been staring at too long.

VOCABULARY FOCUS

10 High-Frequency Words to Know

These recur often enough in AMCAT verbal sections to be worth memorizing cold.

Abate

to reduce or diminish in intensity

Diligent

hardworking and careful

Frugal

economical, careful with money

Hostile

unfriendly, antagonistic

Judicious

sensible, showing good judgment

Candid

frank and honest, straightforward

Eloquent

fluent and persuasive in speech

Gregarious

sociable, fond of company

Impede

to hinder or obstruct

Lethargic

sluggish, lacking energy

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Opening → Closing → Connectors. In that order, every time.
- 2 90 seconds per para-jumble. Guess and move on if you're not sure.
- 3 Know your time budget before the mock starts, not during it.
- 4 Vocabulary is a habit, not a cram — a little daily beats a lot occasionally.